

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto and previously in the Metrolinx Service Design office. Builds single-source performance data from operational sources that do not agree, analyses run-time and reliability patterns across a rail network, and turns the findings into reporting senior staff decide from.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, combining several years of data from separate operational sources into one validated source the division reports from, so performance is tracked continuously rather than rebuilt each quarter.
- Analyze travel and network data for trends and emerging issues, and establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Write the briefing notes and presentations that carry findings to planners, engineers and managers across divisions.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a resolution.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, schedule reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Analysed run-time and speed profile patterns across subdivisions to find where schedules were most exposed to variance.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to settle the variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Performance analytics, KPIs and reliability reporting. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and large operations datasets. OpenTrack rail simulation, VISSIM, Synchro and MATSim. Dashboards and single-source reporting. Briefing notes and presentations for senior audiences. MS Office, including large multi-source Excel workbooks.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)